

Green anaconda

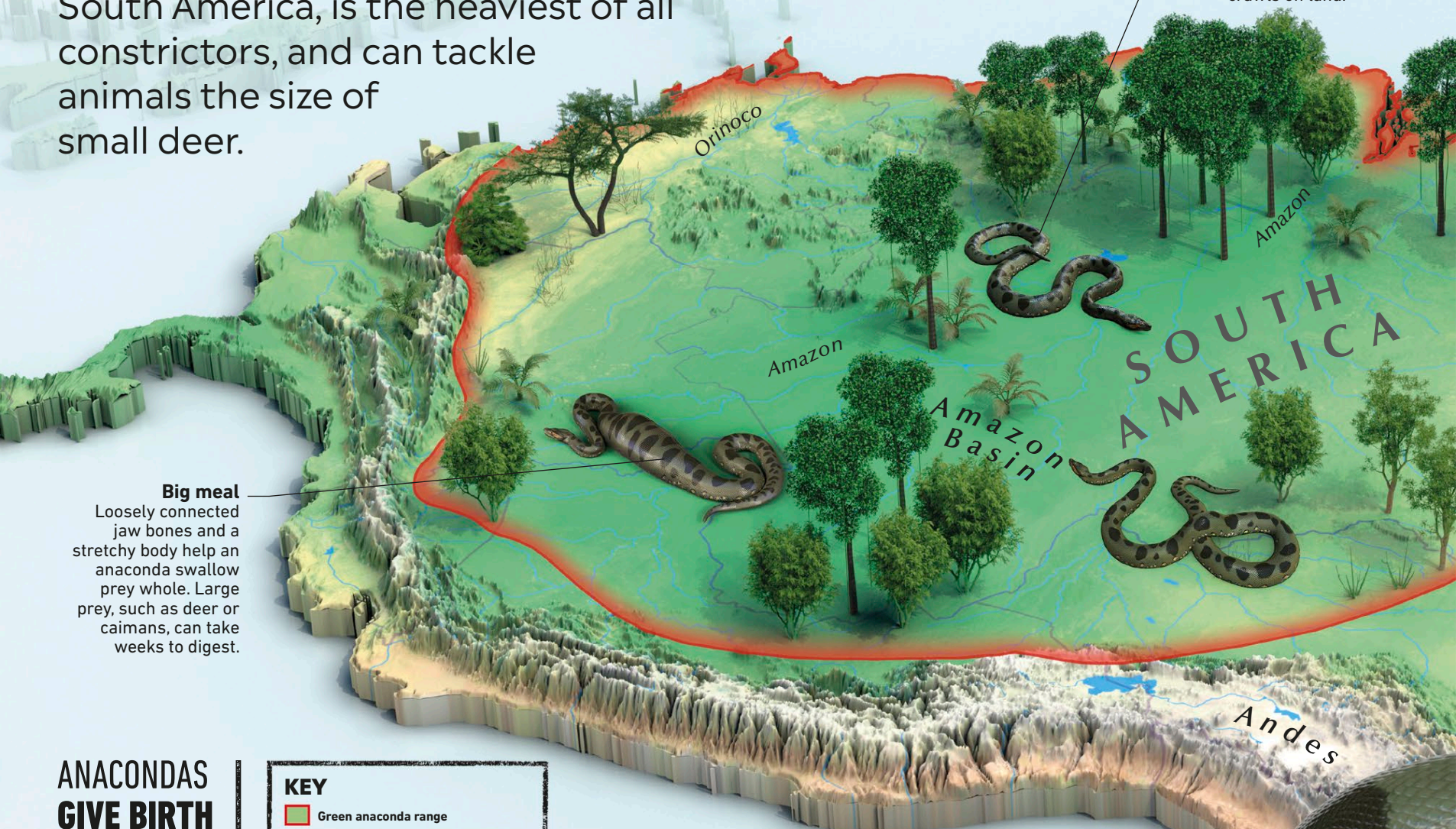


All snakes prey on other animals, but the biggest kill by constriction, rather than venom.

The green anaconda, at home in South America, is the heaviest of all constrictors, and can tackle animals the size of small deer.

River snake

More than 1,000 rivers run through the Amazon Basin, making it the perfect habitat for the green anaconda, which can swim faster than it crawls on land.



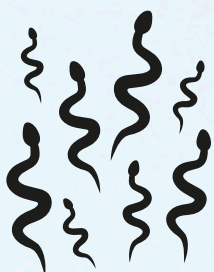
Big meal

Loosely connected jaw bones and a stretchy body help an anaconda swallow prey whole. Large prey, such as deer or caimans, can take weeks to digest.

**ANACONDAS
GIVE BIRTH
TO UP TO**

50

**YOUNG
AT A TIME**

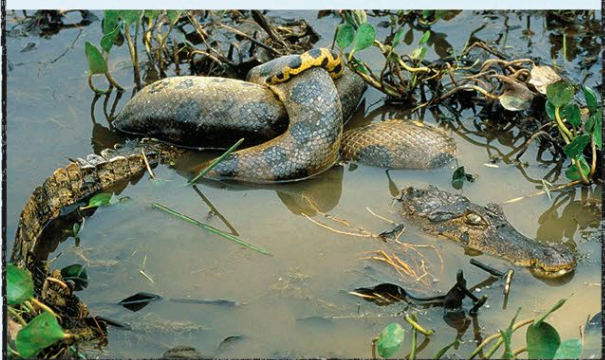


KEY

 Green anaconda range

Squeezed prey

Constrictors such as anacondas kill not by crushing, but by suffocation. The snake squeezes tighter each time its victim exhales, so breathing becomes impossible, and the heart stops.



Wetland giant

The green anaconda grows so heavy that adult snakes tend to stick to rivers and wetlands, where their bodies are supported by water. The river-filled Amazon Basin merges with grasslands in the south, where much of the land is flooded during the rainy season, making a large part of South America prime anaconda habitat.

